Georgina Mace



Born in London in 1953, Georgina Mace had a huge impact within conservation biology, partly due to her work with the IUCN, where she led the development of universal criteria for inclusion of species on the Red List. Using her criteria, the Red List identified thousands of species and habitats at risk of extinction. This led to the UN Convention on Biological Diversity (2002), which aimed to significantly reduce the rate of biodiversity loss by 2010.

Mace's major contributions to science led to many international honors, such as the Linnean Medal, and she was the first female President of the British Ecological Society. Her work to protect biodiversity and highlight how human well-being depends upon it continued up until her death in 2020.

Key works

1991 *Assessing extinction threats: toward a reevaluation of IUCN threatened species categories*

2014 *Whose conservation?*

2018 *Aiming higher to bend the curve of biodiversity loss*

See also: Ecological resilience • Climax community • Metapopulations • Mass extinctions • Deforestation